



THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

UBC Beamer Template

Research presentation

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September 23, 2026



This template is based on [the CUHK Beamer Template](#) by [Rui HU](#), which is an adaptation to [SINTEF Presentation](#) from [Federico Zenith](#), and its derivation [Beamer-LaTeX-Themes](#) from Liu Qilong.

UBC style adaptation contributed by [Haonan Bai](#) in 2026.

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Beamer for UBC slides

1 Introduction



- We assume you can use $\text{\LaTeX}$; if you cannot, [you can learn it here](#)
- Beamer is one of the most popular and powerful document classes for presentations in $\text{\LaTeX}$
- Beamer has also a detailed [user manual](#)
- Here we will present only the most basic features to get you up to speed

Beamer vs. PowerPoint

1 Introduction



Compared to PowerPoint, using $\text{\LaTeX}$ is better because:

- It is not What-You-See-Is-What-You-Get, but What-You-Mean-Is-What-You-Get: you write the content, the computer does the typesetting
- Produces a pdf: no problems with fonts, formulas, program versions
- Easier to keep consistent style, fonts, highlighting, etc.
- Math typesetting in $\text{\LaTeX}$ is the best:

$$i\hbar\frac{\partial}{\partial t}\Psi(\mathbf{r},t) = -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m}\nabla^2\Psi(\mathbf{r},t) + V(\mathbf{r})\Psi(\mathbf{r},t)$$

Getting Started

Selecting the UBC Theme



To start working with the UBC theme, start a $\text{\LaTeX}$ document with the preamble:

Minimum UBC Beamer Document

```
\documentclass{beamer}
\usetheme{ubc}
\begin{document}
\begin{frame}{Hello, world!}
\end{frame}
\end{document}
```

Title page

1 Introduction



To set a typical title page, you call some commands in the preamble:

The Commands for the Title Page

```
\title{Sample Title}  
\subtitle{Sample subtitle}  
\author{First Author, Second Author}  
\institute{The University of British Columbia}  
\date{\today} % Can also be (ab)used for conference name &c.
```

You can then write out the title page with `\maketitle`.

To set a **background image** use the `\titlebackground` command before `\maketitle`; its only argument is the name (or path) of a graphic file.

If you use the **starred version** `\titlebackground*`, the image will be clipped to a split view on the right side of the title slide.

Writing a Simple Slide

It's really easy!



- A typical slide has bulleted lists

Writing a Simple Slide

It's really easy!



- A typical slide has bulleted lists
- These can be uncovered in sequence

Writing a Simple Slide

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Code for a Page with an Itemised List

```
\begin{frame}{Writing a Simple Slide}  
  \framesubtitle{It's really easy!}  
  \begin{itemize}[<+>]  
    \item A typical slide has bulleted lists  
    \item These can be uncovered in sequence  
  \end{itemize}\end{frame}
```

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Changing Slide Style

2 Personalization



- You can select the white or *maincolor* **slide style in the preamble** with `\themecolor{white}` (default) or `\themecolor{main}`
 - You should *not* change these within the document: Beamer does not like it
 - If you *really* must, you may have to add `\usebeamercolor[fg]{normal text}` in the slide
- You can change the **footline colour** with `\footlinecolor{color}`
 - Place the command *before* a new frame
 - Use a dark colour with the white footer text:  `ubcblue` or  `ubcsecondary`
 - Default is no footline; you can restore it with `\footlinecolor{}`
 - Others may work, but no guarantees!
 - Should *not* be used with the *maincolor* theme!

Blocks

2 Personalization



Standard Blocks

The header follows the footline colour; the body uses a neutral background.

```
\begin{block}{title}  
content...  
\end{block}
```

Colour Blocks

Similar to the ones on the left, but you pick the colour. Text will be white by default, but you may set it with an optional argument.

```
\begin{colorblock}[ubcblue]{ubclightblue}{title}  
content...  
\end{colorblock}
```

Use dark text on light backgrounds and white text on dark backgrounds.

Using Colours

2 Personalization



- You can use colours with the `\textcolor{<color name>}{text}` command
- The colours are defined in the `ubccolor` package:
 - Primary colour:  `ubcblue`
 - Secondary blues:  `ubcsecondary`,  `ubcsky`,  `ubclightblue`
 - Template neutrals:  `ubcgrey`,  `ubctext`
 - Semantic alert colour:  `ubcalert`
 - See the [UBC colour guidelines](#) for the official palette. Neutral and alert colours are template choices.
- Do not abuse colours: `\emph{}` is usually enough
- Use `\alert{}` to bring the focus somewhere

Using Colours

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- Do not abuse colours: `\emph{}` is usually enough
- Use `\alert{}` to bring the focus somewhere
- If you highlight too much, you don't highlight at all!

Adding images

2 Personalization



Adding images works like in normal $\text{\LaTeX}$:

Code for Adding Images

```
\usepackage{graphicx}  
% ...  
\includegraphics[width=\textwidth]  
{assets/ubc/ubc-crest-blue}
```



Splitting in Columns

2 Personalization



Splitting the page is easy and common; typically, one side has a picture and the other text:

This is the first column

And this the second

Column Code

```
\begin{columns}
  \begin{column}{0.6\textwidth}
    This is the first column
  \end{column}
  \begin{column}{0.3\textwidth}
    And this the second
  \end{column}
  % There could be more!
\end{columns}
```



Special Slides

2 Personalization

- Chapter slides
- Side-picture slides



Chapter slides

2 Personalization



- Similar to frames, but with a few more options
- Opened with `\begin{chapter}[\<image>]{\<color>}{\<title>}`
- Image is optional, colour and title are mandatory
- Dark backgrounds keep the white chapter text legible:  `ubcblue` or  `ubcsecondary`.
 - It may still be a nice touch to change the footline of following slides to the same color of a chapter slide. Your choice.
- Otherwise, `chapter` behaves just like `frame`.

Side-Picture Slides

2 Personalization

- Opened with `\begin{sidepic}{<image>}{<title>}`
- Otherwise, `sidepic` works just like `frame`



Fonts

2 Personalization



- The paramount task of fonts is being readable
- There are good ones...
 - Use serif fonts only with high-definition projectors
 - Use sans-serif fonts otherwise (or if you simply prefer them)
- ... and not so good ones:
 - Never use monospace for normal text
 - Gothic, calligraphic or weird fonts should always be avoided



- To insert a final slide with the title and final thanks, use `\backmatter`.
 - The title also appears in footlines along with the author name, you can change this text with `\footlinepayoff`
 - You can remove the title from the final slide with `\backmatter[notitle]`
- The aspect ratio defaults to 16:9, and you should not change it to 4:3 for old projectors as it is inherently impossible to perfectly convert a 16:9 presentation to 4:3 one; spacings *will* break
 - The `aspectratio` argument to the `beamer` class is overridden by the UBC theme
 - If you *really* know what you are doing, check the package code and look for the `geometry` class.

Citation

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- you can cite your reference use `\cite{}`, e.g. [Thought et al.(1979)]. The Reference will be shown in the last page.

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Good Luck!

3 Summary



- Enough for an introduction! You should know enough by now
- Template source and feedback: [UBC-Beamer-Template](#)

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- [1] Deep Thought, Ford Prefect, Roosta, and Zarniwoop. 1979.
Answer to the Ultimate Question of Life, the Universe, and Everything.
The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy (1979), 42.



UBC Beamer Template

Thank you for listening!

Any questions?